

HOUSE RESOLUTION 256

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to honor Coach Scott Shephard for his leadership, service, and lasting contributions to girls' lacrosse at Ooltewah High School and in Hamilton County.

WHEREAS, over the past eleven years, the girls' lacrosse program at Ooltewah High School has grown from an initial concept into a respected, competitive, and school-sanctioned athletic program; and

WHEREAS, Ooltewah High School was the first high school in Hamilton County to offer a girls' lacrosse team, establishing a foundation for the sport in the region; and

WHEREAS, in the absence of an established blueprint, feeder programs, or institutional support, Coach Scott Shepherd, alongside his wife, Tara Shepherd, demonstrated initiative and leadership by creating the Ooltewah Lady Owls Lacrosse Club, a 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization, with Coach Shepherd leading coaching efforts and Mrs. Shepherd managing operations with the support of a governing board; and

WHEREAS, Coach Shepherd began by building the program at the club level, recruiting players, organizing facilities, and teaching the fundamentals of lacrosse to student athletes who often had no prior exposure to the sport, successfully forming a competitive varsity-level team within six months each year; and

WHEREAS, through persistence and advocacy, the program achieved official recognition and sanctioning, representing a significant milestone for Ooltewah High School and advancing opportunities for girls' athletics throughout the region; and

WHEREAS, as the Southeast representative for the Tennessee Girls' Lacrosse Association (TGLA), Coach Shepherd played a vital role in promoting and advancing the sport until it achieved sanctioned status; and

WHEREAS, under Coach Shepherd's leadership, approximately 200 student athletes have participated in the program, with approximately 160 games coached, achieving a record of 64-95-1 and qualifying for four regional playoff appearances; and

WHEREAS, eight student athletes from the program have advanced to compete at the collegiate level across NAIA, Division III, and Division II institutions, gaining both athletic and academic opportunities; and

WHEREAS, beyond athletic accomplishments, Coach Shepherd has instilled values of resilience, discipline, teamwork, and perseverance, contributing to the personal development and confidence of his student athletes; and

WHEREAS, Coach Shepherd has made significant personal sacrifices, dedicating countless hours to practices, competitions, travel, and mentorship, while consistently advocating for resources, recognition, and expanded opportunities for his players; and

WHEREAS, through challenges, growth, and the demands of building a program from the ground up, Coach Shepherd has remained a steady and respected leader, positively impacting the lives of young women both on and off the field; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we recognize and commend Coach Scott Shepherd for his outstanding leadership, dedication, and service to Ooltewah High School, Hamilton County, and the advancement of girls' lacrosse. His contributions have left a lasting legacy in the development of student athletes and the growth of the sport, and his efforts serve as an example of commitment, perseverance, and community impact.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.

